

STAGE ONE • SELF-AWARENESS & CAREER CLARITY

FIRSTS

ADAPTATION NOTES

Online vs. in-person format notes for every activity that changes shape

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

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PURPOSE

Every activity in this program should work equally well whether you're running it in a room together or on a video call — but “equally well” rarely means “identically.” A paired interview that works naturally when two chairs turn to face each other needs a breakout room and an explicit timer online. A full-group round that flows naturally in person can stall badly on video without a structured way to call on people.

This document covers every activity across Stage One's Session Plan, Group Versions of Key Exercises, and Icebreakers documents that genuinely changes shape between formats, with a specific note for each. Activities not listed here (most solo worksheet time) don't meaningfully change between formats — only the ones below need real adaptation.

Format Notes by Activity

Activity	In-Person	Online
Icebreakers (all 3)	Small clusters of 3-4 chairs, no tables needed — keeps it casual and fast.	Breakout rooms of 3, 4-5 minutes, with the prompt pasted in chat before you send people in. Bring everyone back and ask 1-2 pairs to share instead of every group.
Solo worksheet time (most FIRSTS)	Participants work at their own table with the printed or tablet Templates workbook; music optional, low volume.	Cameras can go off during solo work — say this explicitly (“feel free to go off camera while you write, I’ll ping you when we regroup”). Share the digital Templates workbook link in chat at the start of the block.
Paired Interview (FIRST 01)	Pairs turn chairs to face each other directly; gives real eye contact for the values-guessing part.	Breakout rooms of 2. Set the timer visibly (screen share or verbal countdown) since pairs can’t see a room-wide time cue the way an in-person group can.
Practice Circle (FIRST 04)	Genuine circles of 3-4 chairs; speaking order goes around physically.	Breakout rooms of 3-4. Ask one person per group to unofficially track speaking order and keep time, since there’s no natural physical cue for whose turn is next.
Research Jigsaw (FIRST 09)	Groups cluster around one shared laptop or take turns on individual devices, then physically regroup to share findings on a whiteboard or flipchart.	Breakout rooms of 3-4 with a shared Google Doc (link in chat) for the group to pool findings live, rather than a physical whiteboard.
Full-group share-outs / closing rounds	Genuine round-robin around the room; comfortable silence is fine while people think.	Use the “raise hand” feature or call names directly from a list rather than open-floor — open-floor rounds tend to stall badly on video since no one can read the room the way they can in person.
Salary Benchmarking research (FIRST 11)	If wifi is unreliable, have 2-3 printed salary platform screenshots ready as backup per common target role.	Confirm everyone can genuinely access salary sites before starting — some corporate or campus networks block them. Have backup screenshots ready as a shared doc link.

GENERAL HYBRID GUIDANCE

For a genuinely hybrid session (some participants in the room, some on video), the single most common failure is the in-room group forgetting the remote participants exist during open discussion. Assign one in-room person each session as the explicit “remote advocate”, watching the chat and periodically pausing discussion to check in on remote participants directly.

For any breakout activity in hybrid, put remote participants together in their own breakout room rather than mixing them into in-room groups — mixed groups where some people are physically present and one is a video tile tend to leave the remote person genuinely sidelined.